GRADE 6 ELA QUESTION BANK

Topic 5: Poetry, Figurative Language, and Literary Devices

150 multiple-choice questions • 50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Instructions: Choose the best answer. Difficulty levels are kept in separate blocks: Easy questions 1–50, Medium questions 51–100, and Hard questions 101–150. An answer key is provided at the end.

EASY QUESTIONS (1–50)

Figurative Language and Comparison

1. Which phrase is a simile?

A. The clouds covered the sun
B. The clouds looked gray
C. The clouds were cotton
D. The clouds moved like ships

2. “The wind whispered through the trees” is an example of—

A. hyperbole
B. end rhyme
C. personification
D. stanza

3. Which phrase is a metaphor?

A. as cold as ice
B. the lake was a mirror
C. cold like ice
D. the lake was very cold

4. Which word imitates a sound?

A. slow
B. crash
C. bright
D. soft

5. Which line uses alliteration?

A. Busy bees buzzed by
B. The bird flew south
C. The sky turned dark
D. A flower opened

6. Which detail appeals to the sense of taste?

A. a ringing bell
B. a scratchy sweater
C. a bright lamp
D. a bitter sip of cocoa

7. What is a stanza?

A. a word that describes a noun
B. the poem's author
C. a group of lines in a poem
D. the final sound in a line

8. Which line uses personification?

A. The clock was round
B. The clock sat on a desk
C. The alarm clock yelled at me
D. The clock showed seven

9. Which pair of words rhymes?

A. warm / wish
B. day / play
C. cat / cup
D. tree / stone

10. What is imagery?

A. language that helps readers picture or sense something
B. a list of characters
C. the name of a poem
D. the number of lines in a poem

Imagery, Mood, Tone, and Connotation

11. Which line appeals to hearing?

A. The blanket felt soft
B. The bread smelled warm
C. The lemon tasted sour
D. The bell clanged loudly

12. “I have a mountain of homework” is an example of—

A. rhyme
B. alliteration
C. stanza
D. hyperbole

13. Which phrase creates a peaceful mood?

A. sirens shrieking in the street
B. footsteps racing behind me
C. gentle waves under a pale sky
D. branches snapping in a storm

14. What does the speaker of a poem mean?

A. the title of the poem
B. the voice speaking in the poem
C. the person who reads the poem
D. the person who prints the poem

15. Which word has a negative connotation?

A. scrawny
B. determined
C. confident
D. slim

16. Which line contains a metaphor?

A. The classroom was a zoo
B. My brother is like a bear
C. The dog ran quickly
D. The rain fell like beads

17. Which phrase appeals to touch?

A. a loud drum
B. a sour orange
C. a sweet smell
D. a rough, scratchy rope

18. What is the theme of a poem?

A. the number of words
B. the place where it was printed
C. a message or lesson about life
D. the pattern of capital letters

19. Which phrase is an example of alliteration?

A. under the bridge
B. tiny turtles tiptoed
C. a blue sky
D. near the house

20. Which line uses a simile?

A. The snow covered the road
B. The snow fell like feathers
C. The snow was a blanket
D. The snow was white

Sound, Rhythm, Rhyme, and Structure

21. What is rhyme?

A. similar sounds, often at the ends of lines
B. a comparison using like or as
C. an exaggerated statement
D. a group of lines

22. Which word most clearly creates a gloomy mood?

A. cheerful
B. playful
C. bright
D. dreary

23. Which line is literal rather than figurative?

A. The stars winked at me
B. The sun smiled at us
C. Rain covered the sidewalk
D. The road swallowed the car

24. Which phrase compares using “as”?

A. the world is a stage
B. the angry clouds
C. as quiet as a mouse
D. the road swallowed us

25. Which line uses onomatopoeia?

A. The water looked calm.
B. Plop! The pebble hit the pond.
C. The pebble was gray.
D. The pond was deep.

26. What is a poem's tone?

A. the speaker's attitude toward the subject
B. the poem's length
C. the feeling the reader gets only
D. the number of stanzas

27. Which line uses a metaphor for time?

A. Time moved like a train
B. Time was measured in hours
C. Time passed slowly
D. Time is a thief

28. Which is a visual image?

A. a soft scarf
B. a loud whistle
C. a bitter taste
D. a bright red kite

29. Which phrase could symbolize hope?

A. a broken alarm
B. a locked empty room
C. a small light in darkness
D. a dark, empty road

30. Which line has end rhyme?

A. The stars were clear
B. The moon shone bright / All through the night
C. The sky was dark
D. The moon rose slowly

Symbolism, Theme, and Interpretation

31. What is a refrain?

A. a line or phrase repeated in a poem
B. a line that never has rhythm
C. a comparison using like or as
D. a type of character

32. Which word suggests a joyful tone?

A. delighted
B. bitter
C. gloomy
D. mournful

33. Which detail appeals to smell?

A. a rough stone
B. a ringing bell
C. a bright sign
D. the scent of pine after rain

34. Which line shows motion?

A. The lamp was yellow
B. The bowl sat on a table
C. The stream raced over rocks
D. The room was square

35. Which phrase is a metaphor for sadness?

A. sad as rain
B. a storm inside my chest
C. I felt unhappy
D. tears fell slowly

36. Which word best completes a rhyme with “light”?

A. long
B. night
C. lamp
D. leaf

37. Which line gives an object a human action?

A. The shadows crept across the wall
B. The room had windows
C. The wall was gray
D. The shadows were long

38. Which line uses a sound word?

A. The garden was quiet.
B. The bee was yellow.
C. The flower opened.
D. Buzz! The bee flew past.

39. Which feature can help create rhythm?

A. the title's font
B. the number of nouns
C. patterns of stressed and unstressed syllables
D. the page color

40. Which line most clearly shows gratitude?

A. A bird rests on a branch
B. The wind bends the grass
C. Your kindness is a lantern for me
D. The road is made of stone

Analyzing Poetic Choices

41. What is a rhyme scheme?

A. the author's biography
B. the pattern of rhymes at line endings
C. the poem's main character
D. the number of metaphors

42. Which phrase has a positive connotation?

A. confident and determined
B. lazy and careless
C. weak and useless
D. mean and cruel

43. Which line creates a sense of sound and movement?

A. The road was narrow
B. The hill was steep
C. The car was red
D. The wheels clattered down the hill

44. Which line contains a simile about speed?

A. She was a racing engine
B. Her shoes were thunder
C. The road swallowed her
D. She ran like an arrow

45. Which word best describes a poem's mood?

A. the writer's name
B. the line count
C. the feeling it creates for readers
D. the book's size

46. Which line contains a metaphor?

A. He spoke softly
B. His words were daggers
C. His words sounded like music
D. He said three words

47. Which phrase appeals to hearing?

A. leaves crackling underfoot
B. a lemon's sour taste
C. a silky ribbon
D. a sweet perfume

48. Which statement about a poem's title is sensible?

A. It may give clues about the subject or meaning
B. It always tells the theme
C. It must rhyme with the last line
D. It never matters

49. Which line uses personification?

A. The sun warmed the sand
B. The sun was bright
C. The sun appeared at dawn
D. The sun peeked over the hill

50. Which phrase best describes a poem's speaker?

A. the poem's final line
B. always the poet personally
C. the voice presenting the poem's words
D. the reader's friend

MEDIUM QUESTIONS (51–100)

Figurative Language and Comparison

51. Read: “The sidewalk swallowed the rain / while streetlights blinked awake.” Which device appears in both lines?

A. allusion
B. personification
C. hyperbole
D. end rhyme

52. In “Her apology was a paper bridge,” what does the metaphor suggest?

A. the apology was written on paper only
B. the apology may be fragile or not strong enough
C. the apology was very loud
D. the speaker crossed a real bridge

53. Which statement best distinguishes tone and mood?

A. Tone is the speaker's attitude; mood is the feeling created for readers
B. They always mean the same thing
C. Tone is the rhyme pattern; mood is the line count
D. Tone is the setting; mood is the speaker

54. A poem follows an ABAB rhyme scheme. What does this mean?

A. only lines 1 and 2 rhyme
B. all four lines rhyme
C. no lines rhyme
D. Lines 1 and 3 rhyme, and lines 2 and 4 rhyme

55. Which revision creates a more vivid image?

A. Rain happened that day
B. It was raining outside
C. The cold rain needled my cheeks
D. The weather was bad

56. A poet repeats a line after each stanza. What is a likely purpose?

A. to fill space without a reason
B. to prove there is no theme
C. to emphasize an important idea or feeling
D. to change the speaker every time

57. Which detail most strongly creates an ominous mood?

A. Fresh bread cooled by the window
B. A door creaked open in the empty hall
C. Sunlight warmed the garden bench
D. Children laughed by the fountain

58. A poem compares memories to “buttons in a jar.” Which meaning is most reasonable?

A. memories are collected and kept
B. the speaker is shopping
C. the jar is only the setting
D. memories are always made of metal

59. Which line uses alliteration most clearly?

A. The night was quiet
B. The stars are far away
C. A bird crossed the sky
D. Silver snakes slide silently

60. A poem uses short, abrupt lines during a chase. What effect is most likely?

A. the poem must be a sonnet
B. the scene must feel calm
C. the theme becomes obvious

D. the pace feels quick and urgent

Imagery, Mood, Tone, and Connotation

61. What is enjambment?

A. when two words begin alike
B. when every line ends with a period
C. when a thought continues beyond the end of a poetic line
D. when all lines have equal syllables

62. Which phrase is a metaphor rather than a simile?

A. Hope burns as if it were fire
B. Hope is a candle in the dark
C. Hope is bright as a flame
D. Hope shines like a candle

63. A “rusted key” appears repeatedly in a poem about a family secret. What might it symbolize?

A. access to something hidden or forgotten
B. the weather outside
C. a brand-new beginning with no past
D. a loud sound

64. Which line uses assonance most clearly?

A. The slow road rolls home
B. The dog barked twice
C. Rain hit the roof
D. A bird sat still

65. A poem shifts from a storm to a calm morning. What should readers examine?

A. the poet's handwriting
B. only the number of letters in each word
C. whether the title is capitalized
D. how the shift changes mood or meaning

66. The phrase “the city is a furnace” appears in a poem about summer. What does it suggest?

A. the city has no buildings
B. the city is literally a factory furnace
C. the city feels intensely hot
D. the speaker is describing winter

67. Which line is an extended metaphor beginning to develop?

A. Questions were asked in class
B. My mind is a garden; each question plants a seed
C. The garden needs water
D. My mind is busy today

68. A poem repeats “still I rise” after descriptions of setbacks. What does the repetition emphasize?

A. the absence of a speaker
B. persistence and resilience
C. confusion about the setting
D. a change to past tense

69. Which feature is most useful when identifying rhythm aloud?

A. the pattern of beats and stresses
B. the number of pages
C. the author's age
D. the paper's color

70. What is symbolism?

A. a statement that must be literal
B. a poem with four lines
C. a word that always rhymes

D. an object or image representing a larger idea

Sound, Rhythm, Rhyme, and Structure

71. A poem describes a “golden cage.” What idea does this image suggest?

A. complete freedom without limits
B. a natural landscape with no barriers
C. beauty or comfort combined with confinement
D. a plain metal tool

72. Which question best helps a reader infer theme?

A. Does every stanza have four lines?
B. Which letter appears most often?
C. What insight about life emerges from the speaker's experience?
D. How many words are in the title?

73. Which line includes onomatopoeia?

A. The branch was old and dry.
B. Crack! The branch snapped underfoot.
C. The tree stood beside the path.
D. Leaves covered the ground.

74. What is a caesura?

A. a pause within a poetic line
B. a comparison using like
C. a repeated opening consonant
D. a rhyme at the end of every stanza

75. A poem starts humorously but ends in regret. What is the likely effect?

A. the speaker must be unreliable
B. the mood must stay the same
C. the poem cannot have a theme
D. the shift makes the speaker's feelings more complex

76. Which detail best supports the idea that a poem celebrates everyday work?

A. a storm destroying a bridge
B. a locked door with no one nearby
C. a crown in an empty room
D. hands rough from planting, baking, and building

77. Which phrase is a mixed metaphor?

A. the plan grew slowly
B. the idea took root
C. nip this problem in the bud before it sails
D. the ship sailed at dawn

78. Why might a poet choose free verse?

A. to make every stanza the same length
B. to shape rhythm and line breaks without a fixed traditional pattern
C. to avoid imagery
D. to ensure every line rhymes

79. Which line creates contrast through juxtaposition?

A. A child laughed beside the ruined wall
B. The day ended at sunset
C. The wall was made of brick
D. The child walked along the road

80. A poem's speaker says, “I praise the storm that broke my roof.” What should readers consider?

A. whether the statement is ironic or reveals an unexpected view
B. whether praise must be literal
C. whether the roof is the only symbol

D. whether all storms are helpful

Symbolism, Theme, and Interpretation

81. Which is the strongest way to support an interpretation?

A. give a reaction with no details
B. summarize the title only
C. guess the poet's private intention as fact
D. cite specific words or lines and explain their meaning

82. Which sound device repeats vowel sounds in nearby words?

A. alliteration
B. onomatopoeia
C. assonance
D. end rhyme

83. What can a change in line length contribute?

A. a guaranteed change in speaker
B. pacing, emphasis, or the shape of an idea
C. only the poem's publication date
D. the number of characters

84. “Winter in my heart” after a friendship ends most likely means—

A. the poem's location
B. emotional coldness or sadness
C. a cheerful celebration
D. a literal change in body temperature

85. Which line is a paradox?

A. The more I learned, the less I knew
B. The bird flew over the fence
C. Rain fell on the roof
D. The lamp glowed in the room

86. What is a volta in a poem?

A. a line with no syllables
B. a repeated title
C. a missing speaker
D. a turn or shift in thought or feeling

87. A seed survives winter and blooms in spring. What idea might this image suggest?

A. the speaker dislikes flowers
B. all plants grow without sunlight
C. renewal can follow a difficult time
D. winter lasts forever

88. A poet places a long pause before the final word. What might this emphasize?

A. the number of stanzas
B. the author's location
C. the final word's meaning or emotional weight
D. the title's spelling

89. Which phrase conveys mixed feelings?

A. I felt only anger
B. I missed the freedom, but feared the open road
C. I was completely delighted
D. I had no doubts at all

90. A recurring image changes from a closed window to an open one. What might this suggest?

A. a movement from isolation toward possibility
B. a change in the poet
C. a change from summer to winter only

D. a fixed meaning with no development

Analyzing Poetic Choices

91. Which claim about a poem is best supported by evidence?

A. The title alone proves the theme
B. The poet definitely wrote it after a private argument
C. The poem means whatever someone first guesses
D. The repeated broken-wing image suggests vulnerability because it appears when the speaker describes loss

92. A poem uses short phrases, then longer flowing lines after forgiveness. What might this change show?

A. that structure has no meaning
B. that the speaker has disappeared
C. that the poem is a limerick
D. a release of tension

93. A “museum of unsent words” is a metaphor for—

A. having no memories
B. words becoming objects
C. unspoken thoughts being preserved and revisited
D. a real museum full of paintings

94. Which evidence might show that a speaker is unreliable?

A. the speaker says “I”
B. the speaker's claims conflict with details in the poem
C. the title contains a noun
D. the poem has four stanzas

95. A poem uses a steady rhyme pattern to describe a chaotic argument. What might this contrast do?

A. contrast controlled form with disorderly events
B. prove the argument never happened
C. always create a happy mood
D. have no possible effect

96. Which statement best describes an ambiguous ending?

A. it allows more than one reasonable interpretation
B. it can only be understood from biography
C. it proves the poem has no meaning
D. the writer forgot to finish

97. “The crown weighed less than the promise” in a poem about leadership suggests—

A. the speaker only likes jewelry
B. the poem has no figurative language
C. a crown is lighter than every promise
D. responsibility may matter more than status

98. A poem repeatedly addresses the sea as “you,” though it cannot reply. What technique is used?

A. literal dialogue
B. end rhyme
C. apostrophe
D. flashback

99. A poet's title seems cheerful, but the ending reveals grief. What should readers do?

A. ignore the final stanza
B. reconsider the title in light of the ending
C. conclude the poem has no mood
D. assume the title is unrelated

100. A poem shifts from “I” to “we” in its final stanza. What might this change suggest?

A. the poem no longer has a speaker
B. the speaker connects a personal experience to a shared one
C. the setting definitely changes

D. the poem must use end rhyme

HARD QUESTIONS (101–150)

Figurative Language and Comparison

101. Read: “I stitched the dawn to yesterday / and wore the seam beneath my coat.” Which interpretation is best supported?

A. the speaker carries the past into a new beginning
B. the speaker has forgotten yesterday
C. the speaker is literally sewing the sky
D. the poem is only about clothing

102. A poem uses “bright darkness” for a character who feels relieved and afraid. This is best understood as—

A. an end-rhyme pattern
B. onomatopoeia
C. a literal description of lighting
D. a paradox expressing mixed emotions

103. A poem repeatedly uses clocks, deadlines, and shrinking shadows. What idea may these images emphasize?

A. gardening techniques
B. a humorous setting
C. time pressure or the passing of life
D. the speaker's job as a clockmaker

104. A bird appears first behind glass and later flying over the sea. What might this development symbolize?

A. the speaker's dislike of water
B. a change in weather only
C. movement from restriction toward freedom
D. a change in bird species

105. A speaker praises a cruel leader with exaggerated compliments. Which device is likely used?

A. literal praise only
B. verbal irony
C. assonance alone
D. a simple simile

106. How can enjambment affect meaning?

A. a thought continues past a line break, delaying completion or adding emphasis
B. it always creates perfect rhyme
C. it removes every pause
D. it makes every line a full sentence

107. A poem's rhythm breaks suddenly when the speaker receives bad news. What is the likely effect?

A. the poem has no structure
B. it guarantees a comic mood
C. it adds an unrelated sound
D. the form mirrors the disruption in the speaker's experience

108. Which statement best distinguishes a symbol from a motif?

A. a symbol must repeat; a motif appears once
B. the terms always mean the same thing
C. a symbol is always a person
D. a symbol carries meaning beyond itself; a motif is an element that recurs

109. A poem about moving away repeats suitcases, doorways, and maps. What should a reader consider?

A. only the number of images
B. that each object is unrelated decoration
C. how these images build ideas about leaving, change, and belonging
D. that the poem is a travel ad

110. Which claim is best supported by textual evidence?

A. the poet definitely wrote it after one specific argument
B. the repeated broken-wing image suggests vulnerability because it appears during descriptions of loss
C. the poem means whatever a reader first guesses

D. the title alone proves the theme

Imagery, Mood, Tone, and Connotation

111. A poem begins with clipped phrases and ends with long flowing lines after forgiveness. What might this structural change show?

A. a release of tension
B. that the speaker stops existing
C. that structure has no meaning
D. that the poem must be a sonnet

112. A “museum of unsent words” most likely suggests—

A. unspoken thoughts being preserved and revisited
B. words literally becoming art
C. a real museum of paintings
D. a lack of memories

113. Which evidence best supports the idea that a speaker is unreliable?

A. the title contains a noun
B. the poem has four stanzas
C. the speaker uses “I”
D. the speaker's confident claims conflict with details revealed in the poem

114. A poet uses regular rhyme to describe a chaotic argument. What might the contrast suggest?

A. the rhyme scheme has no effect
B. traditional rhyme always creates happiness
C. the controlled form contrasts with the disorder being described
D. the argument never happened

115. Which best describes an ambiguous ending?

A. it proves the poem has no meaning
B. it allows more than one plausible interpretation supported by the poem
C. the writer forgot to finish
D. it can only be understood through biography

116. “The crown weighed less than the promise” most likely suggests—

A. a crown is lighter than every promise
B. responsibility may matter more than status
C. the speaker is describing jewelry only
D. the poem has no figurative language

117. A poem's speaker repeatedly corrects their own statements. What might this reveal?

A. uncertainty or a changing understanding
B. a lack of poetic structure
C. that the speaker is absent
D. an automatic rhyme scheme

118. Which line creates a layered metaphor for memory?

A. I remember the beach
B. The beach was wide
C. The shells were small
D. Memory is a tide that returns with altered shells

119. A dash appears just before a confession. What effect might it create?

A. proof that the confession is false
B. evidence the punctuation is accidental
C. hesitation or a sudden change in thought
D. a rhyme scheme

120. How can a reader judge whether a poem's form supports its theme?

A. count words only
B. focus only on biography

C. examine how structure, rhythm, line breaks, and sound work with the ideas
D. assume form and meaning are unrelated

Sound, Rhythm, Rhyme, and Structure

121. A city is “a thousand separate windows, each holding a different moon.” What might this suggest?

A. the city has no people
B. people share a place but have different private experiences
C. every window contains a real moon
D. the speaker is giving an architecture report

122. A poem contains images of both leaving and returning. What is a careful interpretation?

A. it may explore a complicated relationship with home or belonging
B. the poem can have only one literal meaning
C. one image must be an error
D. the title alone settles the conflict

123. Which line uses metonymy, referring to an institution through something associated with it?

A. The king wore a crown
B. The crown was made of gold
C. A crown fell from a shelf
D. The crown announced a new law

124. “Silence is a room we built together” suggests that silence—

A. requires an empty room
B. means the speaker is an architect
C. is literally a building
D. may be a shared condition created by more than one person

125. Which interpretation is best supported by repeated doorway images and the speaker's hesitation at each threshold?

A. the poem means sadness only
B. the poem is definitely about a specific person
C. the images suggest choices or decisions
D. the first image determines every meaning

126. A final image changes the meaning of a symbol that appeared earlier. What effect can this create?

A. it removes all links to earlier stanzas
B. it invites readers to rethink earlier parts of the poem
C. it makes interpretation impossible
D. it proves the poem has no ending

127. Which statement best explains poetic ambiguity?

A. the wording supports more than one reading connected to the poem's details
B. any interpretation is equally supported
C. unclear words make interpretation impossible
D. ambiguity means no theme exists

128. A compass spins whenever a speaker must choose. What might it symbolize?

A. difficulty finding direction or certainty
B. a literal weather forecast
C. a completed journey
D. a reliable sense of purpose

129. What is the best way to compare two poems about grief?

A. compare only their titles
B. assume they say the same thing
C. choose the sadder one without evidence
D. compare imagery, speakers, tone, structure, and conclusions using evidence

130. “The silence after the last note was another kind of music.” What does this paradox suggest?

A. there is no sound imagery
B. the speaker dislikes music

C. quiet can still carry emotional meaning
D. silence literally makes musical notes

Symbolism, Theme, and Interpretation

131. Which is the strongest analysis of a poem's final turn?

A. ignore the earlier stanzas
B. explain how the shift changes or complicates earlier ideas
C. assume the last line is always the theme
D. repeat the last line without analysis

132. A bridge is called “half promise, half warning.” What tension does this create?

A. it is only a physical structure
B. it may offer connection while also presenting risk
C. it means every journey is safe
D. the speaker has no mixed feelings

133. A poem's title seems cheerful, but the last stanza describes loss. What is a strong reading strategy?

A. reconsider the title's meaning after reading the ending
B. conclude the poem has no theme
C. ignore the ending
D. assume the title is unrelated

134. A poem shifts from “we” to “I” near the end. What should readers investigate?

A. whether the shift is automatically an error
B. whether the poem has rhyme
C. whether the poet changed their name
D. whether the shift changes the speaker's sense of shared or personal responsibility

135. Why might a poet break a familiar rhyme pattern at the climax?

A. it has no effect if there is a title
B. it always means the poem is unfinished
C. the change may signal an emotional or thematic shift
D. it proves the poet cannot rhyme

136. A locked gate appears throughout a poem, but the speaker ends by saying, “I stopped searching for the key.” What might this imply?

A. the gate has disappeared
B. the poem is about home repairs only
C. the speaker is changing their response to an obstacle
D. the speaker has found the key

137. Which evidence best supports a critique of consumerism?

A. one shopping bag with no context
B. repeated images of price tags, disposable goods, and people treated like products
C. the author's name
D. the presence of a metaphor

138. A lullaby-like rhythm accompanies an unsettling event. What effect may result?

A. an eerie contrast between soothing form and disturbing content
B. a shift to factual writing
C. no mood at all
D. proof the event is harmless

139. How should a reader interpret a mythological reference in a poem?

A. ignore nearby lines
B. assume every reader knows the myth
C. assume the poem is ancient
D. use relevant associations and the poem's context to explain its effect

140. Which statement best explains how sound reinforces meaning?

A. sound never affects meaning

B. every poem must use one sound device
C. rhyme always contradicts the subject
D. harsh consonants may intensify a conflict scene when paired with violent actions

Analyzing Poetic Choices

141. A poem's recurring color appears in different situations. What is the best analysis method?

A. give it one universal meaning without reading
B. assume it was chosen randomly
C. track where it appears and infer its meaning from context and change
D. ignore changes across stanzas

142. Which claim is strongest when interpreting a complex poem?

A. it means sadness because I feel sad
B. repeated doorway images suggest choices, supported by hesitation at each threshold
C. the poem is definitely about one real person
D. the first image decides all meanings

143. A poem's ending transforms a recurring symbol instead of fully resolving it. What can this do?

A. invite readers to reinterpret the symbol and earlier moments
B. make interpretation impossible
C. prove the poem has no ending
D. remove every connection to earlier stanzas

144. A poem describes “the last light in the window” as a guide. What interpretation is most reasonable?

A. it may represent hope or connection, depending on context
B. it must be a literal lighthouse
C. it has no possible symbolic meaning
D. it always means danger in every poem

145. Which detail most clearly suggests the speaker has mixed feelings about returning home?

A. The house has a blue roof
B. The street is two blocks long
C. I arrived at noon
D. The door feels familiar, yet the hallway seems strange

146. A poem uses the same image at the beginning and end, but the speaker's attitude changes. What should a reader notice?

A. the ending is unrelated
B. the poem has no structure
C. the repeated image may gain a new meaning because of the speaker's change
D. the image must mean exactly the same thing

147. Which approach best supports a comparison of poetic techniques?

A. list the poets' names only
B. identify specific devices in both poems and explain their effects
C. count lines without discussing meaning
D. describe personal preference only

148. A poem says, “I planted a question and harvested doubt.” What is the strongest interpretation?

A. the speaker is literally farming questions
B. asking the question led to uncertainty or deeper reflection
C. the speaker has no doubts
D. the line describes a real crop

149. A poem's central image changes meaning after the speaker learns a secret. What should a strong analysis explain?

A. how the new information changes the reader's understanding of the earlier image
B. why the title must be literal
C. only how many times the image appears
D. why every image has one fixed meaning

150. A poem ends with a question that is never answered. What is the most reasonable interpretation?

A. the poem is automatically incomplete
B. the question cannot contribute to theme
C. the speaker has no point of view
D. the unresolved question may invite readers to consider the poem's conflict

ANSWER KEY

Grade 6 ELA • Topic 5: Poetry, Figurative Language, and Literary Devices

Questions 1–50: Easy • 51–100: Medium • 101–150: Hard

1	D	31	A	61	C	91	D	121	B
2	C	32	A	62	B	92	D	122	A
3	B	33	D	63	A	93	C	123	D
4	B	34	C	64	A	94	B	124	D
5	A	35	B	65	D	95	A	125	C
6	D	36	B	66	C	96	A	126	B
7	C	37	A	67	B	97	D	127	A
8	C	38	D	68	B	98	C	128	A
9	B	39	C	69	A	99	B	129	D
10	A	40	C	70	D	100	B	130	C
11	D	41	B	71	C	101	A	131	B
12	D	42	A	72	C	102	D	132	B
13	C	43	D	73	B	103	C	133	A
14	B	44	D	74	A	104	C	134	D
15	A	45	C	75	D	105	B	135	C
16	A	46	B	76	D	106	A	136	C
17	D	47	A	77	C	107	D	137	B
18	C	48	A	78	B	108	D	138	A
19	B	49	D	79	A	109	C	139	D
20	B	50	C	80	A	110	B	140	D
21	A	51	B	81	D	111	A	141	C
22	D	52	B	82	C	112	A	142	B
23	C	53	A	83	B	113	D	143	A
24	C	54	D	84	B	114	C	144	A
25	B	55	C	85	A	115	B	145	D
26	A	56	C	86	D	116	B	146	C
27	D	57	B	87	C	117	A	147	B
28	D	58	A	88	C	118	D	148	B
29	C	59	D	89	B	119	C	149	A
30	B	60	D	90	A	120	C	150	D